

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared on a business website:

Wearable smart devices are here!

Wearable smart devices, commonly known as wearables, have become popular over the last ten years. Smartwatches like the Apple Watch are likely the best-known ones. But there are many other kinds of new smart devices you can wear on your body now, including clothing and jewellery. Let's take a look at two of them.

Smart Ring. The most common kind of smart jewellery might be the smart ring. Smart rings are worn on the finger like regular rings. But they can collect health-tracking data for the users and allow them to review it on a smartphone later. Compared to a smartwatch, the smart ring is less distracting since it cannot receive messages and can only track the user's health. And if you don't like rings, there are also smart bracelets created by well-known fashion brands.

Smart Clothing. By covering a large amount of a user's body, smart clothing can provide more information than other wearable devices. It allows for better medical care and lifestyle improvement. For example, there are smart shirts capable of diagnosing respiratory diseases, smart shoes that monitor running performance, smart yoga pants that vibrate to improve form during exercises, and smart swimsuits that alert the user to apply sunscreen. A luxury brand also added location-tracking to its jeans to track how frequently the customer wore them, so that the brand can reward frequent wearers with more of its products.

Your class is doing a project on new technologies and your group is discussing wearable smart devices. You may want to talk about:

- why wearable smart devices are becoming popular
- the disadvantages of wearable smart devices
- whether wearable smart devices should be allowed at school
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you or your friends have a wearable smart device?
2. Would you buy a wearable smart device?
3. Do you prefer a smart watch or a smart ring?
4. Do you think wearable smart devices are a waste of money?
5. Do you think there are too many smart devices in our lives?
6. Are wearable smart devices fashionable?
7. Can using wearable smart devices help us become healthier?
8. Would you be concerned about privacy if you wore a wearable smart device?